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Vault Structure Best Practices

Updated 2 months ago

What is the Fireblocks Vault?

Think of the Fireblocks Vault as a safe room in a bank. The safe room contains many drawers, each with a different lock and key. As a Fireblocks customer, you control the Vault (safe room) and can organize the vault accounts (drawers) to your preference. Each vault account supports a single asset wallet for each asset type. These wallets contain unique deposit addresses and keys on the blockchain.

We recommend organizing your Vault using a segregated structure or a sweep-to-omnibus structure. While there are fundamental practical differences, both structures use the blockchain as a single source of truth ledger.

[Learn about all the possibilities for structuring your Fireblocks Vault.](#)

Managing your assets

For managing your organization's assets, we recommend setting up a "Treasury" vault account to safely store your assets. This account should have the most restrictive Policy rules.

If you manage various operations with teams that need different access to funds, we recommend creating a vault account per team or operation.

[Learn more about the segregated Vault structure.](#)

Managing your end-client funds

Grouped funds

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If you need to separate your clients' funds from one another for regulatory reasons or accounting purposes, we recommend creating one vault account per customer to track and manage deposits.

If you want to manage customer deposits from a single account, we recommend creating a central Omnibus vault account where deposits can be swept.

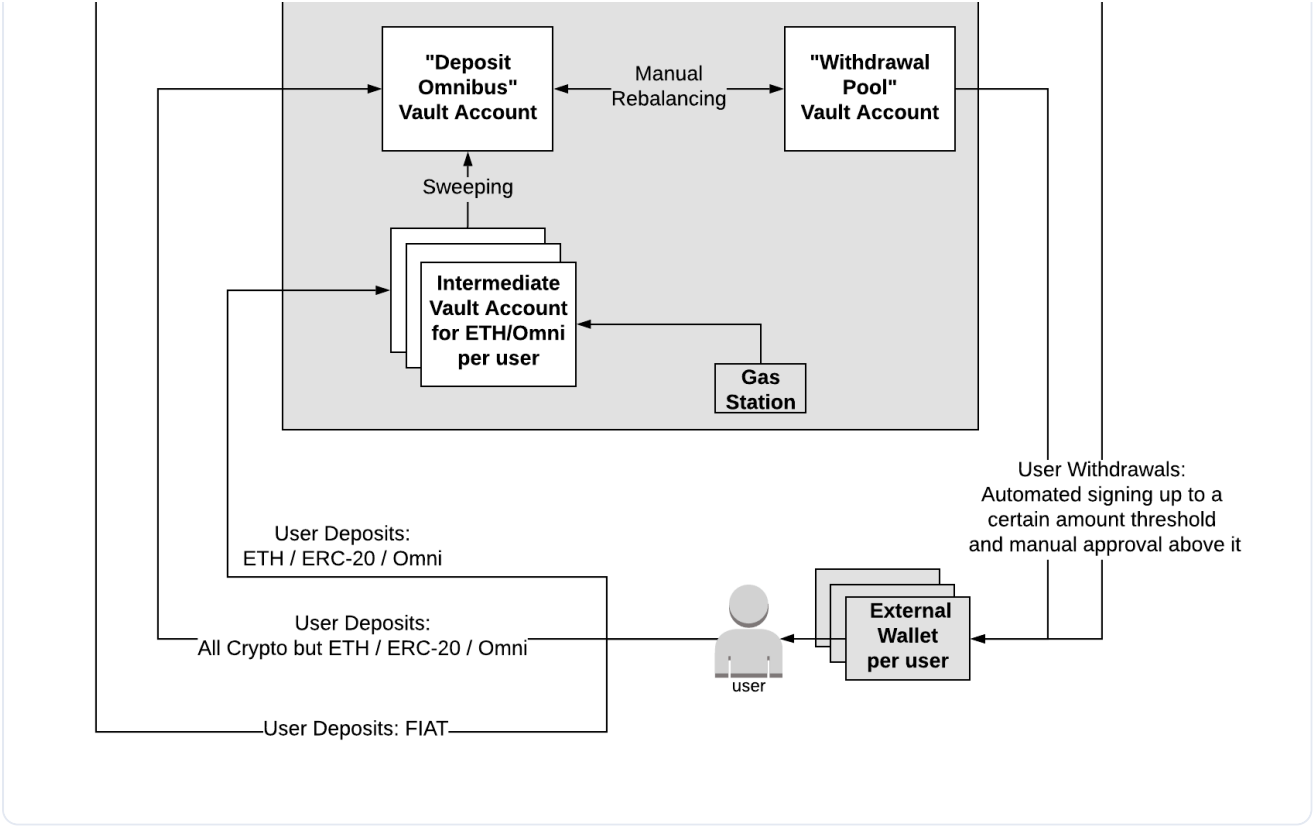
For UTXO-based assets and blockchains that support multiple addresses:

- You can assign each client a unique deposit address within the Omnibus vault account. These addresses are derived from the permanent wallet address of the UTXO asset.
- Clients can deposit funds directly to their assigned address in the Omnibus vault account.
- You can invest funds from multiple end-client deposits with unified transactions from the Omnibus Deposits vault account.
- This also applies to blockchains that support multiple addresses using optional memos, notes, or tags. [Learn more about using other deposit addresses.](#)

For account-based assets:

- You must create individual vault accounts for each client to have their own unique address. Ethereum and other EVM-compatible blockchains can't have more than one address per vault account.
- These intermediary vault accounts receive customer deposits, and you can sweep the funds periodically to the Omnibus vault account.

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[Learn more about the sweep-to-omnibus structure.](#)

Segregated vs. Sweep-to-omnibus

Segregated
Sweep-to-omnibus

Recommended Vault structure per use case

Use Case		Vault structure
Treasury Management	Self Custody	Segregated
	Liquidity Management	Segregated

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	Non-financial	Sweep-to-Omnibus
Token Lifecycle Management	Financial assets	Segregated
	Non-financial assets	Segregated
Clearing & Settlement Services	N/A	
Payments	Merchant settlement	Segregated
	Cross-border payments	Segregated
	Payouts	Segregated
	Payins	Both

Other considerations

Web3

We recommend using a segregated Vault structure for Web3 or Decentralized Finance (DeFi) operations when your wallets are:

- Separated based on decentralized app (dApp)
- Used by distinct users or teams

Otherwise, you can use the sweep-to-omnibus Vault structure for your Web3 operation.

Smart contracts

A segregated Vault structure is typically preferred for managing smart contracts. Rather than simply using your wallets as an address for moving funds, each wallet's address is associated with elevated privileges, such as minting, burning, or other operations, within the smart contract.

We recommend creating vault accounts for these operations: Mint, Burn, Pause, Deploy, Upgrade, and other privileged contract calls. Each user role in the smart contract will have a designated vault account, and Policy rules allow only the relevant personnel to use those vault accounts.

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- Deploying smart contracts
- Upgrading smart contracts
- Role allocation

2. An **Operational** workspace used mainly for minting and burning.
3. A **Custodial** workspace used for your custody or your customer's custody.

For non-financial or lower-value financial use cases, the overhead of maintaining three workspaces may be excessive for the risk profile. In this case, it may be suitable to utilize only two workspaces by consolidating the administrative and operational functionality into a single workspace.

When using your own smart contracts, you can seek advice from Fireblocks Professional services.

Offline storage

Suppose some of your funds should be stored offline to comply with local regulations. In that case, we recommend purchasing a [Fireblocks Cold Wallet workspace](#) and rebalancing it with your hot workspace to manage your liquidity.

Automation

If you're scaling for hundreds and thousands of customers, we recommend using an API Co-Signer to automatically sweep funds according to your organization's logic and fee prices.

When sweeping funds, you pay a fee in the base asset of the deposited token's blockchain. To ensure you always have enough funds for the sweeping transaction, we introduced the [Fireblocks Gas Station feature](#) that automatically identifies incoming transactions to your pre-defined vault accounts and deposits enough of the base asset to cover fees for sweeping funds to your main treasury.

When would you need a separate Fireblocks workspace?

A single workspace can hold both segregated and sweep-to-omnibus structures!

When your business use case requires more than vault account segregation, you can request to purchase additional workspaces. This is applicable when:

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workspace and can be accomplished by designing a separate workspace for each customer.

- You want to give your employees different viewing privileges on vault accounts.
- You want to create different configurations. For example:
 - Different AML defaults (such as fail-on-unknown versus pass-on-unknown)
 - Different DeFi approval cap limit
 - Allowing the use of Raw Signing
- Your customer requires the workspace to be run in a separate geographical location. In that case, it would be necessary for them to have a separate workspace.

How do I restrict the visibility of Vault accounts?

By default, all users in the workspace have visibility to all of the Vault accounts in the workspace. To restrict visibility to end users:

- Reach out to your Customer Success Manager to request a new workspace and limit the users on the new workspace to those you want to have overall visibility.
- Limit visibility at the API level by creating a custom application or user interface that integrates with Fireblocks via an API user. Your custom app/UI would include logic to limit end-users' visibility to only their assigned Vault account.

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